3.1 Essentials of trust and integrity

The constituents of trust and integrity are represented by the two quad charts in figure 3.1, one showing the components of trust and the other showing the elements of integrity. Spend a few minutes reviewing figure 3.1, and identify the various components of trust and integrity before we explore these concepts further.

3.1.1 Trust

Trust means different things in different contexts. Trust is an essential criterion for the success of any system. So let’s first define trust in the context of blockchain-based decentralized systems.

> **DEFINITION** *Trust* is a measure of confidence in the credibility of a peer participant in a system. Trust in a blockchain-based system is established by verification and validation of relevant participant data and transactions, and by immutable recording of appropriate information done with the consensus of the stakeholders.